

WE ARE PLAYING DICE WITH THE NATURAL ENVIRONMENT

THE ECONOMIC IMPACT OF CLIMATE CHANGE

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

William Nordhaus (1941–)

BEFORE

1993 In *Reflections on the Economics of Climate Change*, William Nordhaus summarizes the issues surrounding climate change and the economy, highlighting uncertainties and potential solutions.

AFTER

2008 In *Common Wealth: Economics for a Crowded Planet*, Jeffrey Sachs argues that although humanity faces daunting economic crises—including that of climate change—we have the knowledge to address them.

2013 *The Climate Casino: Risk, Uncertainty, and Economics for a Warming World*, by William Nordhaus, explains how global warming relates to the world's economy, and provides ideas for reducing its impact.

Climatology is an uncertain science. Future projections will change, based on human actions and new technology, as well as natural cycles. However, it is vitally important to assess the financial impacts of climate change. Once potential costs are understood, we can explore ways in which to mitigate its direct impacts. It is necessary to consider not only the direct